Fly GACA — Decision Log

SECTION 01-governance   TYPE document   STATUS active   OWNER Founder   UPDATED 2026-08-26

> Live decision log. Continues the series from `decision-log-template.docx` (DEC-001 … DEC-005). Log every decision that is (a) strategic, (b) irreversible or expensive to reverse, (c) likely to be questioned by investors/board, or (d) cross-functional — within 7 days of being made.
>
> Owner of the log: Captain Adel Yahya A. Madkhali, Founder · i@flygaca.com Confidential — Not for Distribution.

Prior entries (in the template): DEC-001 me-central2 region · DEC-002 Gemini for inference · DEC-003 Moyasar for payments · DEC-004 Apache 2.0 licensing · DEC-005 60-day academy pilot.

These entries (DEC-006 …) record the July 2026 shift from *build* to *go-to-company* — the decisions captured in `00-strategy/ceo-execution-roadmap-2026-07.md`.

DEC-006 — Why go-to-market and legal existence now, not more product build

Field	Detail
Date	2026-07-02
Decision	Freeze new product/brand/localization work and run the go-to-company critical path — engage the IP lawyer, lock the name, register the legal entity, and land the first paying customer — as the sole priority for Q3 FY2026.
Reversibility	Two-way door — building can resume anytime. But the opportunity cost is one-way: weeks spent building are weeks the company still does not legally exist and has no revenue.
Owner	Founder
Stakeholders Consulted	Founder (solo); advisory review
Review Date	2026-09-24 (end of Sprint 3)

Context. The product is feature-complete and deployed (`flygaca-firebase.web.app`): library, Captain Adel cited AI, 162-question study bank, 21 tools, Arabic RTL, offline PWA, launch SEO. The company, however, is not legally registered, has never engaged the IP lawyer, has zero customers and zero revenue. The product roadmap itself concludes "the legal/entity track is now the critical path — the product itself is built," yet recent work was Arabic localization and a repo reorg — more building. Continuing to build is the comfortable, controllable work; it is also avoidance of the externally-gated work that actually makes this a company.

Options Considered.

- *Keep building* (more features/localization/docs before going to market) — Pro: in the founder's control, low external friction. Con: the company still does not exist or earn; compounds sunk cost under an unresolved brand name.
- *Go-to-company now* (freeze build, run lawyer→name→entity→first customer) — Pro: moves the only two scoreboard numbers that matter (legal existence; paid customers); time-critical before the 12 Aug 2026 copyright law. Con: forces the uncomfortable, gated, external work.
- *Hybrid — build + slowly pursue legal* — Pro: feels balanced. Con: in practice the legal track keeps losing to the buildable track (the last month proves it); the critical path needs to be the *only* path to actually move.

Rationale. The scoreboard is being changed from "features shipped / documents written" to "does the company legally exist, and how many customers have paid." Everything already built is preparation for those two numbers; the gap is entirely on the far side of the founder's comfort zone. For a different choice to be right, the product would have to be the binding constraint on revenue — it is not; legal existence and demand are.

DEC-007 — Why engage a Saudi IP lawyer now, ahead of the 12 Aug 2026 copyright law

Field	Detail
Date	2026-07-02
Decision	Engage one of the shortlisted Saudi IP firms in Sprint 0 (this week) to deliver a written opinion on (a) GACAR/AIP redistribution rights and (b) the "Fly GACA" name/trademark exposure — accounting for the **new** copyright law, not the 2003 law.
Reversibility	Two-way door on the engagement; the *timing* is effectively one-way — an opinion obtained after 12 Aug 2026 may miss the window to shape pre-launch decisions cleanly.
Owner	Founder
Stakeholders Consulted	Shortlisted IP firms (`02-legal/lawyer-shortlist.md`); brief ready (`02-legal/lawyer-brief`)
Review Date	2026-07-30 (opinion in hand)

Context. The lawyer brief has been ready for weeks but unsent. Two open risks (P0-1 corpus rights, P0-2 name) are gated on it, and P0-3 entity registration is gated on the name lock that only the opinion unblocks. A new Saudi Copyright Law takes effect **12 August 2026**, with SAIP implementing regulations on the official-documents exclusion and the AI -training exception landing then — both central to Captain Adel's corpus rights.

Options Considered.

- *Self-assess on desk research* — Pro: free, immediate. Con: not legal advice; corpus rehosting and the name both carry real exposure; investors/academies will ask.
- *Engage now (fixed-fee, conflict-checked)* — Pro: unblocks name→entity→revenue; opinion reflects the new law. Con: cost; forces the name decision.
- *Wait until after 12 Aug 2026* — Pro: opinion reflects final implementing regs. Con: stalls the entire critical path 6+ weeks; leaves the name unresolved while brand cost compounds. Rejected.

Rationale. One email unblocks the name, the corpus position, and the entity. It is the single highest-leverage action available and it is time-boxed by the 12 Aug law. Ask each firm for a fixed-fee quote, turnaround, and a conflict check (do they act for GACA?).

DEC-008 — Why resolve the "Fly GACA" name before further brand investment

Field	Detail
Date	2026-07-02
Decision	Gate all further brand, print, and localization spend on the lawyer's name opinion; lock the final name (keep "Fly GACA" / demote to tagline + register a distinct mark / rebrand) before any additional brand work or the entity registration.
Reversibility	The *name itself* is a one-way door for practical purposes — a post-launch rebrand touches the repo, domains, brand assets, entity name, print collateral and the Arabic tree. Cheap to change now, expensive later.
Owner	Founder
Stakeholders Consulted	IP lawyer (pending, DEC-007)
Review Date	2026-07-30 (name locked)

Context. Desk research (P0-2) finds "Fly GACA" may be **unregistrable** as a trademark and carries passing-off exposure because it contains "GACA," a government authority's designation; SAIP can refuse marks implying official endorsement, and a disclaimer is necessary but not sufficient. Every week of building/localizing under the name raises the switching cost of a forced rebrand.

Options Considered. (For the lawyer to weigh — decision to *gate on the opinion* is what is logged here.)

- *Keep "Fly GACA"*, accept possible unregistrability, mitigate with prominent disclaimers.
- *Demote "Fly GACA" to a descriptive tagline*, register a distinct primary mark.
- *Rebrand* the primary name to one without "GACA." ("Captain Adel" / `captadel.com`, already owned, is unaffected either way and is a natural fallback front door.)

Rationale. The name is the highest-leverage unresolved question and the most expensive to get wrong after launch. Freezing brand spend until it is locked protects against pouring more sunk cost into a name that may have to change. `captadel.com` is already secured as a hedge.

DEC-009 — Why sequence revenue B2B-schools-first, before consumer checkout

Field	Detail
Date	2026-07-02
Decision	Pursue B2B academy seat-licences as the first revenue line — quoted and invoiced manually (ZATCA e-invoice + `grantSchoolLicence`) — ahead of consumer online checkout, which is gated on the legal entity and the payment gateway.
Reversibility	Two-way door — both lines run in parallel eventually; this is a sequencing/priority call, not an exclusion.
Owner	Founder
Stakeholders Consulted	Founder; CS playbooks (`08-customer-success/`)
Review Date	2026-09-24

Context. Consumer checkout cannot open until the legal entity exists (P0-3) and the payment gateway is live (Moyasar, per **DEC-003**). Schools, however, can be quoted and invoiced **today** via a manual ZATCA e-invoice and the existing admin grant callable — the only invoice-able revenue path pre-entity. Year-1 logic: ~10 schools × ~50 seats × ~SAR 249 ≈ **SAR 125k ARR**, dominant until consumer checkout opens.

Options Considered.

- *B2B-first* — Pro: invoice-able now, recurring, sticky, provides demand proof before more building. Con: longer sales cycle; founder-time-intensive.
- *Consumer-first* — Pro: larger TAM, self-serve. Con: fully blocked until entity + gateway; no revenue possible before then. Rejected as first mover.
- *Wait for both* — Con: forfeits the one revenue line available now. Rejected.

Rationale. B2B is the only revenue that can be earned before the entity and gateway exist, and a signed pilot is the most valuable demand signal available — worth more than any feature. It gets the founder's selling time from Sprint 1.

DEC-010 — Moyasar confirmed as the KSA payment gateway; Stripe code kept dormant

Field	Detail
Date	2026-08-09
Decision	**Moyasar is the payment processor that goes live for KSA B2C checkout** (flygaca.com and captadel.com), reaffirming DEC-003 and matching the invoicing docs (Qoyod + Moyasar wiring). The built-but-dormant Stripe integration (`functions/stripe.js`) is **kept, not deleted**, as the fallback/expansion rail for non-KSA cards; it stays out of the launch path.
Reversibility	Two-way door — Stripe code remains in the repo and can be activated later; the decision removes a documentation contradiction, not a capability.
Owner	Founder
Stakeholders Consulted	Founder (solo)
Review Date	2026-08-27 (Sprint 3 — gateway live in test mode)

Context. A contradiction was flagged 2026-07-02 (governance flag): DEC-003 logged **Moyasar** (Saudi-licensed, mada-capable, Fatoora-compatible), while `03-finance/monetization.md` described **Stripe** as the built checkout. The consumer price card, the Qoyod e-invoicing decision (`04-compliance-ksa/fatoora-phase2-decision-2026-07.md`) and the VAT procedure (`03-finance/invoicing-and-vat-returns.md`) all already assume Moyasar.

Options Considered.

- *Moyasar live, Stripe dormant* — Pro: the logged decision of record; mada/local rails for KSA consumers; consistent with the Qoyod + VAT docs. Con: new integration work in the highest-load sprint (Sprint 3).
- *Stripe live, revisit Moyasar later* — Pro: `functions/stripe.js` is built and unit-tested. Con: contradicts DEC-003; leaves mada coverage for KSA consumers open; every finance/compliance doc would need rework. Rejected.
- *Both live at launch* — Pro: coverage. Con: doubles integration and reconciliation load on a solo founder in the paywall sprint. Rejected for launch.

Rationale. One processor at launch, and it's the one the legal/financial stack is already built around. Moyasar's mada support is the deciding factor for KSA consumers; Stripe remains the pre-built fallback for international cards whenever it's worth the reconciliation overhead. iOS payments are unaffected in either case (RevenueCat IAP).

DEC-011 — Re-cut the price card, retire the Student tier, and adopt package B2B pricing

Field	Detail
Date	2026-08-19
Decision	The consumer and B2B price card is replaced wholesale by the card now in `03-finance/monetization.md`: Pro **79/mo · 649/yr**; Exam Season Pass **299 / 90 days** (replacing the 199 / 120-day "Exam Term"); exam-prep packs banded by content depth at **249 / 399 / 499**; All-Access Bundle **1,499**; Captain Adel credits **39** / 50 answers. The **Student tier is removed entirely**. B2B moves from per-seat bands to annual packages — Cohort **12,000/yr** (25 seats), Academy **39,000/yr**, Institution **from 72,000**. The licensed Captain Adel API is priced for the first time at **499 / 1,999 / 6,999** per month.
Reversibility	Two-way door on the numbers; one-way-ish on the Student tier, since removing a plan people may already hold is harder to undo than a price change. No customer holds a paid plan yet — checkout has never been open — so the cost of this change is documentation only.
Owner	Founder
Stakeholders Consulted	Founder (solo)
Review Date	2026-11-19 (first full quarter after checkout opens)

Context. Two problems, found together. First, the displayed prices and the charged prices had drifted apart on every SKU — worst on the B2B cohort, where the site advertised SAR 6,000 and the documented deploy charged SAR 2,499. Second, the **Student tier charged less than Pro for an identical entitlement** and its eligibility check (`isStudentEmail`) was never wired to any route, so it was strictly the better buy for every visitor and Pro's price was decorative.

Why these numbers. Benchmarked against three anchors rather than a rival — there is no GACAR competitor at any price. (1) The international question-bank band: a single written costs SAR 188–244 at ASA/Dauntless/Sheppard, a full-year EASA bank SAR 860–960. (2) Saudi purchasing power: SAR 29–55/month is the corridor local consumer subscriptions occupy, and domestic exam-prep edtech sells one-time at SAR 199–400. (3) The buyer's committed spend: a cadet is already paying SAR 60,000–250,000 for training, and a single GACA practical exam costs SAR 2,000. A Gulf pilot pays ~SAR 1,970/year for Jeppesen Middle East charts alone.

Why packages instead of per-seat B2B. Every aviation-ops vendor prices per aircraft with unlimited students, so a per-seat card invites the objection "we already pay SAR 37/aircraft for everything." The package hides the seat and sells the admin/readiness dashboard.

What this supersedes. The June-2026 price card in DEC-009's revenue logic, and the per-seat school card carried in `03-finance/finance-strategy.md`, `00-strategy/roadmap.md`, `07-gtm/`, `09-investor-relations/` and `02-legal/order-form-template-2026-07-03.md`. Those documents are corrected; the dated records that quote the old card (board packs, prior audits, this log's earlier entries) are **left intact** — they are the record of what was decided then.

Note on DEC-010. Its reasoning stands, but its premise has moved: the dormant Stripe integration it preserved **no longer exists**. The Firebase Functions codebase it referred to was replaced by an Express service on Cloud Run, and no Stripe code was carried across. Moyasar is the only payment rail, as DEC-003 and DEC-010 both intended.

DEC-012 — Adopt a bounded internal agent layer, and say what it does not replace

Field	Detail
Date	2026-08-26
Decision	Adopt a **capped** internal agent layer in `ay2m/Office` — four subagents (`doc-smith`, `ar-mirror`, `ksa-compliance`, `family-warden`), governed by a written earn-its-place test in `06-operations-it/agent-workforce-plan.md`. Formally retire `flygaca-qa-reviewer`. Record that this layer substitutes for **none** of the six roles in `05-people/job-descriptions-pack.docx`. Exclude `ay2m/FlyGACA-ios` from the roster pending its removal and restart.
Reversibility	**Two-way door.** Deleting a `.claude/agents/*.md` removes an agent with no downstream effect — nothing in CI, the print pipeline or the family contract depends on any of them. The cap is the part that is meant to persist.
Owner	Founder
Stakeholders Consulted	Founder (solo)
Review Date	2026-11-26

Context. Agents already do real work here and have for months — `00-strategy/phase0.md` lists *"Claude = research / scaffolding done in this workspace"* as a first-class **owner** alongside "You" and "Lawyer", and `.claude/agents/` has held two subagents since the repo was reorganised. What was missing was any governance over it. A third subagent, `flygaca-qa-reviewer`, was **deleted without a record**, leaving live references in two documents; and no document anywhere connected the agent layer to the hiring plan, so the two have been drifting past each other. An investor asking "who does the work?" needs a written answer that is neither "a team we do not have" nor "AI does it."

Options Considered.

- *Leave it ad-hoc* — Pro: free, and it has worked so far. Con: the silent deletion of `flygaca-qa-reviewer` is proof that the layer changes without a trace, and its own reversed `me-central1`/`me-central2` line is proof that an ungoverned agent can carry a load-bearing factual error for weeks.
- *A large role-mapped roster* mirroring the six planned hires — Pro: legible, looks like an org chart. Con: it implies a substitution that is not true, and every agent file is a maintenance surface with no CI behind it. Twelve sections would become twelve agents by gravity alone.

- *A bounded roster with a written cap* — chosen. The failure mode of an agent layer is accumulation, not absence. The cap is the actual decision; the four agents are just today's instance of it, and the rejected candidates are recorded in the plan so the fifth has to be argued for.

What this does not do. It does not move the month-9 ML/AI Engineer or any other role in `05-people/job-descriptions-pack.docx`, and it does not touch the unsized bridge those hires are gated on. It does not close any owner decision. `09-investor-relations/investor-thesis.md` names the solo founder's bus factor as an open diligence item, and this decision leaves that exactly where it was.

On the retirement. `flygaca-qa-reviewer`'s consistency-sweep function moves to `family-warden`, deliberately narrowed to reconcile against a named source rather than re-derive facts. Following the precedent this log set in DEC-011, the dated audit records that reference the old agent — `06-operations-it/qa-consistency-sweep-2026-06-14.md` and `repo-health-report-2026-06-16.md` — are **left intact**; they are the record of what was true then. The retirement is recorded forward-only, here and in `.claude/agents/README.md`.

Open, not decided here. The founder's name is recorded two ways across the tree — "Captain Adel Al-Subaie" in the May/June briefings and `02-legal/lawyer-brief.md`, "Captain Adel Yahya A. Madkhali" in the June/July governance, HR and legal documents. That is a legal-identity question with trademark consequences, and it is logged as an open question in the plan document rather than normalised inside an agent-roster change.

DEC-013 — Reconcile the Phase 2 plugin architecture onto the plugins that already shipped

Field	Detail
Date	2026-08-26
Decision	Treat the **existing** repo plugins as the Phase 2 architecture rather than building the planned set beside them: `flygaca-product` is the `product-engineering` plugin, `captain-adel-service` is `flight-service`, `family-orchestrators` is `fly-gaca-operations`. Complete `flygaca-product` with the five planned skills and a `feature-launch` command; remove the three content-free stub plugins from `ay2m/Office`; convert `office-governance` to the real plugin-manifest format and register it in the family marketplace. Keep `/security-hardening` and `/perf-sprint` family-level, not per-repo.
Reversibility	**Two-way door.** Every change is an added or deleted Markdown/JSON file under `.claude/`; nothing in CI, the print pipeline or the family contract depends on any plugin. The removed stubs carried a manifest and no content — recoverable from git history if the planned naming is ever preferred.
Owner	Founder
Stakeholders Consulted	Founder (solo)
Review Date	2026-11-26

Context. `06-operations-it/phase2-multi-repo-architecture.md` was written against a roster that did not match the repositories. Its Phase 2.2 called for a `product-engineering` plugin in `ay2m/FlyGACA` carrying five agents; that repo had already shipped `flygaca-product`, covering the same five domains under repo-native names, in the correct manifest format, registered in the marketplace, with content grounded in real paths and gates. Building the planned plugin as written would have left one repo with ten agents for five jobs — the exact failure the architecture's own success criterion #2 ("No Duplication") names.

Why reconcile rather than rename. Renaming `flygaca-product` and its five agents to the plan's names would have matched the document at the cost of churning the marketplace entry and every existing reference, to no functional gain. The document is the artifact that was wrong, so the document was corrected — it now carries a planned-name → actual-plugin mapping at the point where a reader would otherwise be misled.

What this exposed. Three claims in the tree were false and are now fixed rather than restated:

- `tools/agents/check-agents.mjs` scanned `plugins/` at the repo root — a path that stopped existing when the tree moved to `.claude/plugins/` in `08147d4`. It had been reporting "all valid" over an empty set, so **no plugin agent was validated by anything**. It now scans the right place, is scoped to `<plugin>/agents/`, and asserts that a plugin agent shadowing a repo agent is byte-identical to it.
- Both product repos' `CLAUDE.md` claimed their agents were "available to this repo via the family contract". The contract carries entity facts, the chat contract and the repo roster; it distributes no agents.
- `ay2m/FlyGACA`'s three-tier corpus policy (`HOST_SAFE_CORE` / `HOST_ORIGINAL` / `DO_NOT_HOST`) appears nowhere in that repo's code or corpus data. It is recorded as stated editorial policy, not an enforced mechanism.

What this does not do. It does not add or retire an agent, so the DEC-012 cap is untouched. It does not exercise `/feature-launch` against a real change — the Phase 2.2 line item "validate with one live feature shipping" remains **open**, and the command should not be described as tested end-to-end until it has driven one.

Living document. Log new strategic decisions here within 7 days. Not legal advice.